LEX-CNF · PRÁCTICA 06

Confusables y palabras sueltas de nivel C2

Hoja 06 · Repaso mixto, nivel alto

Part 1: 8 ítems (1–8) · Part 4: 6 ítems (25–30) · 20 puntos · tiempo orientativo: 25 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

Formato real del examen. En esta hoja, las cuatro opciones de cada hueco de la Part 1 son, casi siempre, un grupo de confusables de la teoría; en el examen se mezclan con collocations, idioms y phrasal verbs.

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Example:

0	**A** craved	**B** yearned	**C** longed	**D** pined

The answer is **A** (craved).

The reluctant celebrity

Ruth Calder has never **(0)** _____ the limelight. In twenty years running Britain's largest chain of bookshops she has given only three interviews, and the one well-known photograph of her – a **(1)** _____ shot of her laughing at a staff party, taken without her knowledge – has been reproduced so often that she says she barely recognises herself.

Colleagues describe her as a **(2)** _____ judge of character who can tell within minutes whether a new manager will last. She expects her staff to be **(3)** _____ – polite and respectful – but she cannot bear flattery.

By 2015 the company had **(4)** _____ its cramped offices in Leeds and moved to a converted mill on the edge of the city, where Calder, characteristically, took the smallest room. That same year she announced a deliberate two-year **(5)** _____ in the company's expansion, to the dismay of shareholders used to a new shop opening every month.

Asked once how she had survived so long in such a cut-throat business, she was silent for a moment, **(6)** _____ rather than downcast, and then said simply: 'I never stopped reading.' Those who saw her **(7)** _____ into last month's annual meeting, upright and purposeful at seventy-one, will not be surprised to learn that she has no plans to retire, although the board has quietly drawn up a succession plan to **(8)** _____ the risks of her eventual departure.

1	**A** frank	**B** candid	**C** blunt	**D** brusque
2	**A** cunning	**B** wily	**C** shrewd	**D** haughty
3	**A** deferential	**B** servile	**C** obsequious	**D** sycophantic
4	**A** outlived	**B** outlasted	**C** outstayed	**D** outgrown
5	**A** hiatus	**B** lull	**C** respite	**D** reprieve
6	**A** brooding	**B** sullen	**C** morose	**D** pensive
7	**A** amble	**B** stride	**C** saunter	**D** trudge
8	**A** quell	**B** allay	**C** mitigate	**D** assuage

Part 4 · Key word transformations

For questions 25–30, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **three** and **eight** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

0 She smiled sadly as she thought about the past.

WISTFUL

She gave a wistful smile as she thought about the past.

The gap can be filled by the words 'a wistful smile', so you write:

0 A WISTFUL SMILE

Write only the missing words IN CAPITAL LETTERS.

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25 As soon as winter began, the mountain roads became impassable.

ONSET

The _____ the mountain roads impassable.

26 From what she said, anyone could tell that she was unhappy in her job.

INFERRED

It _____ what she said that she was unhappy in her job.

27 The young violinist looked sad and disappointed when she heard the judges announce the winner.

CRESTFALLEN

The judges' announcement of the winner _____.

28 Looking after three small children on her own, she has found this year very difficult.

TRYING

Looking after three small children on her own has _____ for her.

29 The two friends fell out over money and have never been reconciled.

RIFT

The _____ money has never healed.

30 The heat drained us of so much energy that we could barely move.

ENERVATING

So _____ that we could barely move.

Hoja de respuestas · Part 1

Escribe la letra elegida (A, B, C o D). Al corregir, marca 1 punto por acierto; una respuesta doble vale 0.

Nº	Respuesta (A–D)	Punto
1		/ 1
2		/ 1
3		/ 1
4		/ 1
5		/ 1
6		/ 1
7		/ 1
8		/ 1
Total		**/ 8**

Hoja de respuestas · Part 4

Nº	Respuesta (en mayúsculas)	Puntos
25		/ 2
26		/ 2
27		/ 2
28		/ 2
29		/ 2
30		/ 2
	Total	/ 12
Total de la hoja		**/ 20**

SOLUCIONES

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución explica por qué es correcta la clave y por qué falla cada distractor, y remite al apartado de LEX-CNF_Teoria_v1 (o de la teoría donde está explicado).

Nº	Clave	Grupo o expresión	Teoría
1	B · candid	frank / candid / blunt / brusque	§3.3
2	C · shrewd	shrewd / astute / cunning / wily	§3.4
3	A · deferential	deferential / obsequious / sycophantic / servile	§3.5
4	D · outgrown	outlive / outlast / outstay / outgrow	§6.3
5	A · hiatus	lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus	§6.2
6	D · pensive	brooding / sullen / morose / pensive	§4.2
7	B · stride	amble / saunter / trudge / stride	§7.1
8	C · mitigate	alleviate / mitigate / assuage / allay	§9.1

1 · B candid

Por qué: a candid shot / photograph: una foto espontánea, tomada sin que la persona pose. Taken without her knowledge lo define.

A frank: frank es «franco» y se dice de personas o conversaciones.

C blunt: blunt es «directo hasta ser brusco»; no describe una foto.

D brusque: brusque es «seco en el trato», solo de personas y modales.

Teoría: §3.3 frank / candid / blunt / brusque

2 · C shrewd

Por qué: a shrewd judge of character: alguien que calibra muy bien a las personas. Es la combinación fija, y can tell within minutes la confirma.

A cunning: cunning implica astucia para engañar; no forma *a cunning judge of character.

B wily: wily es «artero, taimado», con matiz de engaño.

D haughty: haughty es «altivo» (§3.2); no tiene que ver con calibrar a la gente.

Teoría: §3.4 shrewd / astute / cunning / wily

3 · A deferential

Por qué: deferential: respetuoso con quien tiene autoridad, sin servilismo. Polite and respectful lo define, y cannot bear flattery descarta los otros tres.

B servile: servile es «servil»: sumisión excesiva, justo lo que ella no tolera.

C obsequious: obsequious es «obsequioso, rastrero»: atenciones excesivas para agradar.

D sycophantic: sycophantic es «adulador»: la adulación que ella no soporta.

Teoría: §3.5 deferential / obsequious / sycophantic / servile

4 • D outgrown

Por qué: outgrow: quedarse pequeño algo para quien ha crecido. Cramped offices y la mudanza lo explican.

A outlived: outlive es vivir más que alguien o sobrevivir a la propia utilidad (outlive its usefulness).

B outlasted: outlast es durar más que algo o alguien (un régimen, un rival).

C outstayed: outstay solo se usa en outstay one's welcome.

Teoría: §6.3 outlive / outlast / outstay / outgrow

5 • A hiatus

Por qué: hiatus: interrupción decidida, a menudo larga, de una actividad. Deliberate y announced lo confirman, y aquí dura dos años.

B lull: lull es una calma pasajera que se produce sola; no se anuncia.

C respite: respite es un alivio de algo desagradable y va con from; la expansión no lo es.

D reprieve: reprieve es un indulto o la salvación in extremis de algo amenazado.

Teoría: §6.2 lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus

6 • D pensive

Por qué: pensive: pensativo, absorto, sin tristeza. Rather than downcast lo deja claro.

A brooding: brooding es rumiar algo con resentimiento o melancolía: no encaja con rather than downcast.

B sullen: sullen es «hosco, enfurruñado».

C morose: morose es «taciturno y abatido»: justo downcast.

Teoría: §4.2 brooding / sullen / morose / pensive

7 • B stride

Por qué: stride: caminar a zancadas, con decisión. Upright and purposeful lo describe.

A amble: amble es pasear sin prisa: no encaja con purposeful.

C saunter: saunter es caminar con aire despreocupado.

D trudge: trudge es caminar con esfuerzo y cansancio: contradice upright and purposeful.

Teoría: §7.1 amble / saunter / trudge / stride

8 • C mitigate

Por qué: mitigate the risks: atenuar riesgos o efectos. Un plan de sucesión reduce el riesgo de su marcha.

A quell: quell es sofocar por la fuerza (§9.3): unos disturbios, una rebelión.

B allay: allay disipa temores o sospechas.

D assuage: assuage aplaca sentimientos penosos (la culpa, la pena).

Teoría: §9.1 alleviate / mitigate / assuage / allay

Part 4 · Key word transformations

Corrige cada ítem por mitades: 1 punto por cada mitad correcta y bien escrita. Se acepta cualquiera de las variantes indicadas; las respuestas fuera de 3–8 palabras o con la palabra clave cambiada valen 0.

25 ONSET OF WINTER MADE (4 palabras)

También vale: ONSET OF [THE] WINTER [IMMEDIATELY / INSTANTLY / AT ONCE] (MADE / RENDERED / LEFT) (4–7) · **VERY ONSET OF [THE] WINTER (MADE / RENDERED / LEFT)** (5–6)

Mitades: onset of winter | (immediately) made

Por qué: The onset of: el comienzo de algo desagradable o que se impone, como el invierno o una enfermedad (§6.1). La frase 2 convierte la oración temporal en sujeto (the onset of winter) y pide un verbo causativo (made / rendered the roads impassable). Onset ya marca el comienzo, así que immediately o the very onset refuerzan as soon as, pero no son imprescindibles.

No puntúa: *SUDDEN ONSET OF WINTER MADE (dice que el invierno llegó de golpe, no que los caminos se cerraran enseguida); *ONSET OF WINTER CAUSED (cause no admite objeto + adjetivo: made o rendered).

Teoría: §6.1 the advent / the onset / the outset / the dawn

26 COULD BE INFERRED FROM (4 palabras)

También vale: COULD [EASILY / CLEARLY / READILY] BE INFERRED FROM (4–5) · **COULD BE (EASILY / CLEARLY / READILY) INFERRED FROM** (5) · **COULD BE INFERRED ON THE BASIS OF** (7)

Mitades: could be inferred | from

Por qué: Infer sth from sth: deducir (§10.1). Deduce quien escucha o lee; quien habla implies. Anyone could tell pasa a la pasiva impersonal con modal: it could be inferred from what she said that….

No puntúa: *COULD BE IMPLIED FROM (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; imply es lo que hace quien habla); *COULD BE INFERRED BY (se deduce from algo).

Teoría: §10.1 imply / infer / insinuate / allude

27 LEFT THE YOUNG VIOLINIST LOOKING CRESTFALLEN (6 palabras)

También vale: LEFT THE [YOUNG] VIOLINIST [LOOKING] [UTTERLY / THOROUGHLY / COMPLETELY / VISIBLY / QUITE] CRESTFALLEN (4–7) · **MADE THE [YOUNG] VIOLINIST [LOOK] [UTTERLY / THOROUGHLY / COMPLETELY / VISIBLY] CRESTFALLEN** (4–7)

Mitades: left the young violinist | looking crestfallen

Por qué: Crestfallen: alicaído, abatido por una decepción que se nota en la cara (§15); recoge a la vez sad y disappointed. Con the announcement de sujeto hace falta un verbo causativo: left sb (looking) crestfallen o made sb look crestfallen.

No puntúa: *LEFT HER CRESTFALLEN (her no tiene antecedente en la frase 2: falta the young violinist); *MADE THE YOUNG VIOLINIST LOOKING CRESTFALLEN (tras make sb va el infinitivo sin to: look).

Teoría: §15 Emociones, relaciones y trato

28 MADE THIS A VERY TRYING YEAR (6 palabras)

También vale: MADE THIS A (VERY / REALLY / PARTICULARLY / EXTREMELY / EXCEPTIONALLY / TERRIBLY / MOST) TRYING YEAR (6) · **MADE THIS (QUITE / SUCH) A TRYING YEAR** (6) · **MADE THIS AN (EXTREMELY / EXCEPTIONALLY / INCREDIBLY / ESPECIALLY) TRYING YEAR** (6) · **MADE THIS YEAR (VERY / REALLY / PARTICULARLY / EXTREMELY / EXCEPTIONALLY / TERRIBLY) TRYING** (5) · **MADE THIS YEAR A (VERY / MOST) TRYING ONE** (7) · **MADE IT A (VERY / REALLY / PARTICULARLY / MOST) TRYING YEAR** (6) · **RENDERED THIS YEAR (VERY / EXTREMELY / PARTICULARLY) TRYING** (5) · **(PROVED / BEEN) (VERY / EXTREMELY / PARTICULARLY / EXCEPTIONALLY) TRYING THIS YEAR** (5)

Mitades: made this a very | trying year

Por qué: Trying como adjetivo: difícil, agotador, que pone a prueba la paciencia (§13). Make + objeto + complemento: has made this a very trying year (o this year very trying); el intensificador recoge very.

No puntúa: *BEEN VERY TRYING (pierde this year: falta información); *MADE THIS A TRYING YEAR (pierde la intensidad de very: falta una mitad).

Teoría: §13 Una palabra, dos significados

29 RIFT BETWEEN THE TWO FRIENDS OVER (6 palabras)

También vale: RIFT BETWEEN THE [TWO] FRIENDS (OVER / ABOUT / CONCERNING / CAUSED BY) (5–7) · **TWO FRIENDS' RIFT (OVER / ABOUT)** (4) · **RIFT THAT (AROSE / DEVELOPED) BETWEEN THE TWO FRIENDS OVER** (8) · **RIFT THAT OPENED UP BETWEEN THE FRIENDS OVER** (8)

Mitades: rift between the two friends | over

Por qué: Rift: ruptura, distanciamiento entre personas o grupos (§15). Fell out over money pasa a sustantivo (the rift between the two friends over money), y has never healed recoge have never been reconciled.

No puntúa: *RIFT OF THE TWO FRIENDS OVER (la ruptura es between dos personas); *RIFT BETWEEN THE TWO FRIENDS FOR (la causa va con over).

Teoría: §15 Emociones, relaciones y trato

30 ENERVATING WAS THE HEAT (4 palabras)

También vale: [UTTERLY / THOROUGHLY] ENERVATING WAS THE (HEAT / HOT WEATHER) (4–6) · **ENERVATING (DID / HAD) THE HEAT (PROVE / BECOME)** (5) · **ENERVATING DID WE FIND THE HEAT** (6) · **ENERVATING WAS THE EFFECT OF THE HEAT** (7) · **ENERVATING AN EFFECT DID THE HEAT HAVE** (7)

Mitades: enervating was | the heat

Por qué: Enervating: que quita las fuerzas, debilitante (§12.2); no significa «que pone nervioso». Recoge drained us of energy. So + adjetivo al principio de la frase exige la inversión: so enervating was the heat.

No puntúa: *ENERVATING THE HEAT WAS (tras so + adjetivo hace falta la inversión: was the heat); *ENERVATED WAS THE HEAT (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; enervated describe a la persona, no al calor).

Teoría: §12.2 Palabras que confunden también a los nativos · UOE-P4 §3.1 Inversión tras adverbiales negativos y restrictivos